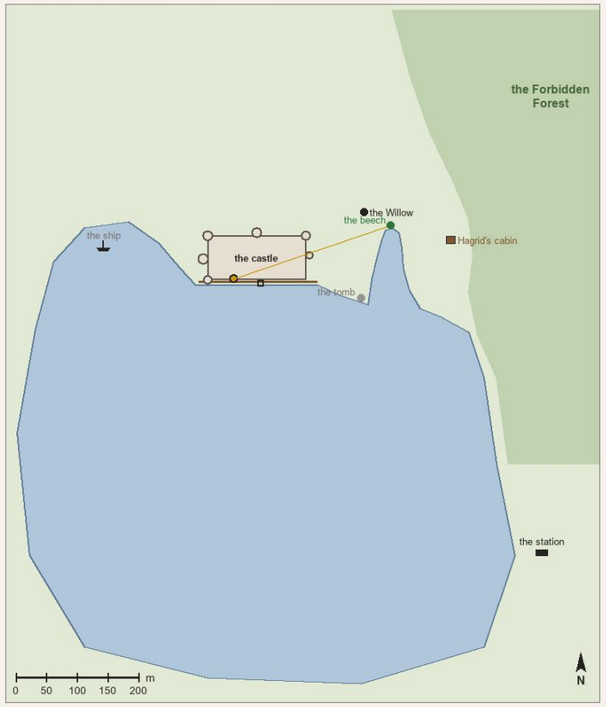
Question 11: the lake's shores, made realistic all the way round

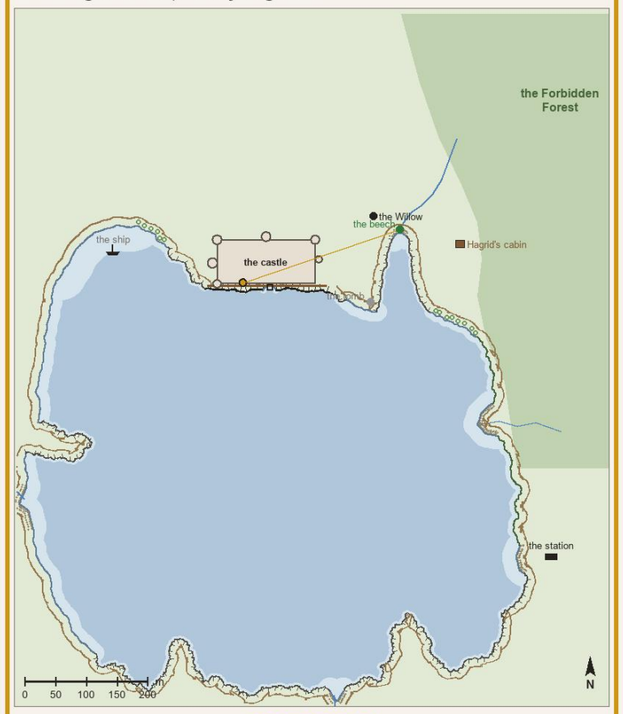
The Architect, 13 October 2026, for Godric, on his note with 225.1: "take advantage of this development in the lake's shape to consider how its shores might be made more realistic around its entire perimeter". Plans north up, 1:10,000 at A3; the castle on its crag (9.1), the lake at -46.

Canon at the gate: rocks and pebbles at the harbour (PS 6); lawns down to a grassy bank, the squid in the shallows by the grass (PS 16, OotP 28); a bank behind shrubs (OotP 38); the ship's anchor in the shallows, a plank onto the bank (GoF 15); a path round the lake (HBP 30, DH 24); the far bank too far to make out a person (PoA 21). No island in the books.

Now as built (225.1, model version 8)

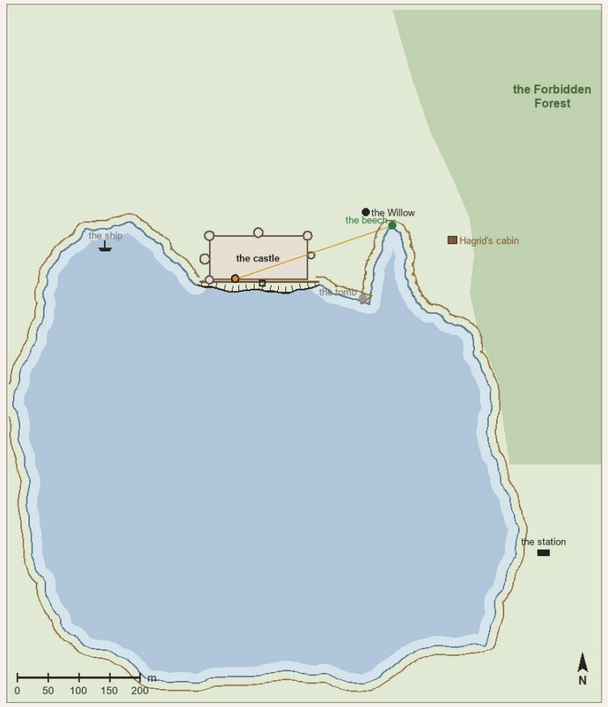


11.1 a Highland loch, read by its ground

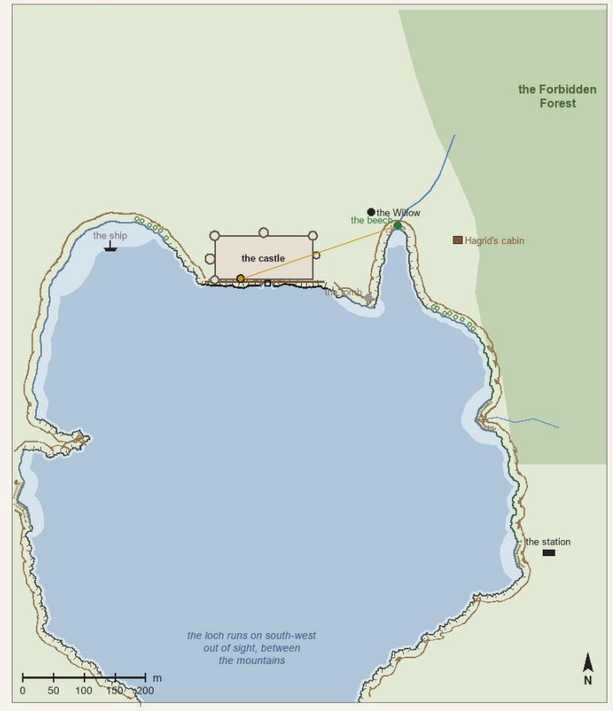


recommended

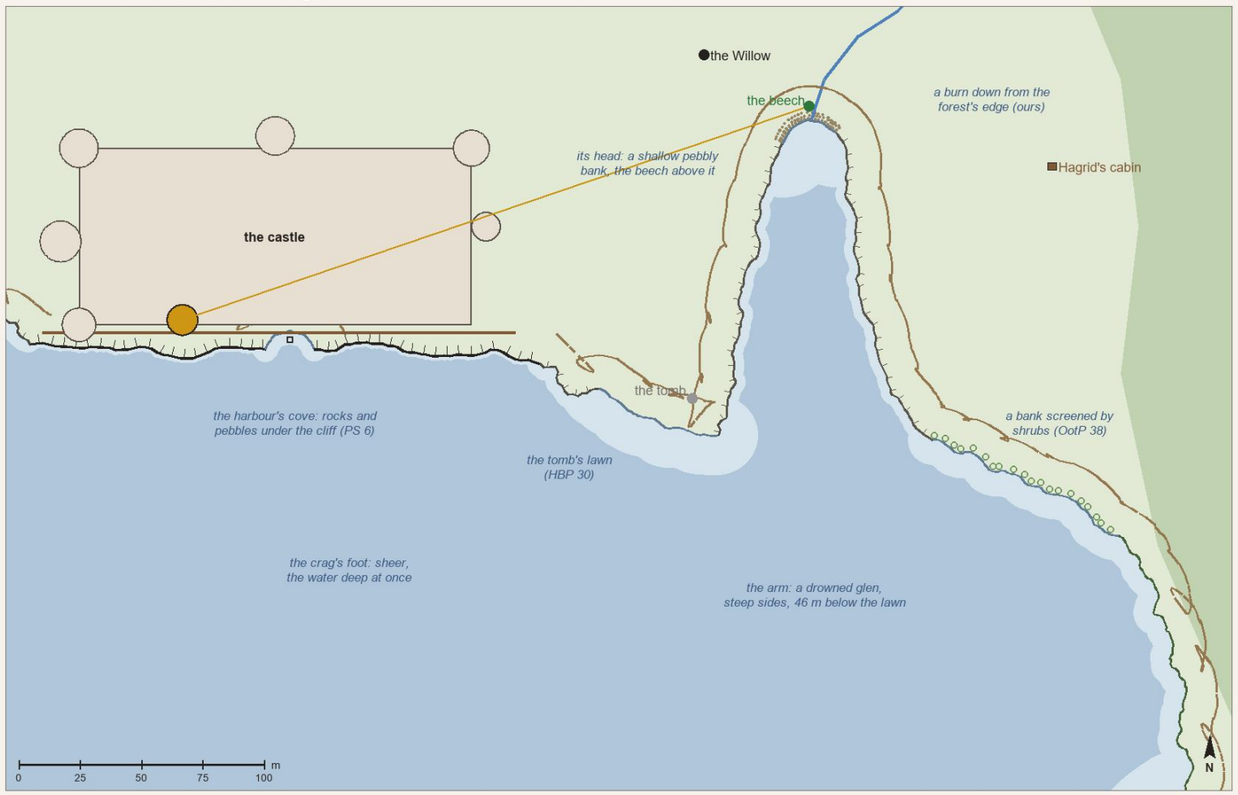
11.2 the same outline, roughened only



11.3 the loch running on south-west



11.1's north-east shore, 1:2,500: the crag, the harbour, the tomb's lawn and the beech's arm



The shores

- the crag's foot, sheer (9.1)
- rock shore, headlands and coves
- the arm's steep glen sides
- lawn to a grassy bank
- a bank behind shrubs
- rocks and pebbles, a burn's fan
- the trees to the water
- the shallows, then deep water
- a burn (ours)
- the path round the lake (HBP 30, DH 24)
- W2's axis to the beech (225.1)

11.1 (recommended): every stretch of shore takes the form of the ground behind it

The crag's foot under the castle stays sheer, the water deep at once (9.1), broken only by the harbour's cove of rocks and pebbles (PS 6). The castle side east and west comes down by lawn to a grassy bank with wide shallows (PS 16, OotP 28); one stretch past the arm is screened by shrubs (OotP 38). The arm is a drowned glen, steep-sided, shallowing to a pebbly head where a burn comes down from the forest's edge, the beech on the bank above it (OotP 17, 29). The forest runs to the water down the east side with a second burn's fan; the first years' shore below the station is a pebbly bay (PS 6); the far shore under the mountains is rock, headlands and coves; the west bay's shallows and bank take the ship's anchor and plank (GoF 15). A path runs round on the bank (HBP 30, DH 24), climbing to the castle where the crag meets the water. No island (none in the books).

11.2: the built outline roughened alike all round, nothing added: more natural to the eye, but every shore the same kind.

11.3: as 11.1 near the castle; past the first years' shore the loch narrows and runs on south-west between the mountains, as Highland lochs do. The far bank of PoA 21 becomes the loch's west side; the views south from the dormitory's W3 and the corridor gain a long reach of water (rows to the Dormitory and the Corridor).

Kept in each: the beech on the water's edge on W2's axis (225.1), the harbour under the cliff, the tomb beside the lake, the ship afloat in the west bay, the station across the water; nothing a room page reads moves. On your word, the chosen outline into page/castle-model.js grounds (the lake's shape and its shores' kinds; version 9).

Measured

now: shore 2810 m, water 48 ha; beech 6 m from the water, ship 37 m off the bank, tomb 6 m; shore crossings 0
11.1: shore 3759 m, water 47 ha; beech 6 m from the water, ship 40 m off the bank, tomb 13 m; shore crossings 0
11.2: shore 2915 m, water 48 ha; beech 5 m from the water, ship 31 m off the bank, tomb 6 m; shore crossings 0
11.3: shore 3078 m in the frame, water 49 ha; beech 6 m from the water, ship 40 m off the bank, tomb 13 m; shore crossings 0